

Kyla Kaplan

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Self-directed MSc FinTech student building software and end-to-end AI systems for financial and industrial applications.

EDUCATION

Università della Svizzera italiana

Lugano, Switzerland

Master of Science in Financial Technology & Computing

Jan. 2025 – Jan. 2027 (exp.)

- **Coursework:** Machine Learning, Distributed Systems, Financial Econometrics, Risk Management

Università della Svizzera italiana

Lugano, Switzerland

Bachelor of Science in Informatics

Sep. 2021 – Jan. 2025

- **Bachelor Thesis (9.5/10):** Built data visualization and analytics tools for Lifeware.

EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer

Dec. 2023 – Present

Squarelife (subsidiary of Lifeware)

Bioggio, Switzerland

- Built CRM/ERP modules for a pan-European insurance platform handling multi-country policy and client data.
- Automated underwriting and back-office processes in Smalltalk, reducing manual processing and error-prone workflows.
- Implemented regulatory and compliance systems, including tax reporting in 3+ countries, FMA requirements (Liste A), and SOC 2 guidelines.

Business Systems Data Analyst

Jul. 2023 – Dec. 2023

Advantive

Remote – Lugano, Switzerland

- Led migration of legacy data to NetSuite & Dynamics 365, improving data integrity and ticket resolution speed by 15%.

Data Analyst Intern

Jul. 2019 – Sep. 2019

NASA (Ames Research Center), via Metis Technology Solutions Inc.

Moffett Field, CA, USA

- Built visualization models for high-fidelity flight simulations used in pilot training and performance analysis.

LEADERSHIP & PROJECTS

MSc Thesis: Deep Learning for Food Label Quality Control (with TIOR SA)

Feb. 2026 – Present

- **Thesis grade: 10/10.** Developed an embedded computer vision system for food label verification, from Raspberry Pi image capture to on-device inference.

Google Summer of Code 2025 (with the Pharo Consortium)

Jun. 2025 – Nov. 2025

- Built an open-source real-time computer vision system for the Cormas simulation platform using YOLO and OpenCV with Python–Pharo integration for object detection, tracking, and agent interaction.

MCP Agent Server for CityFALCON

Apr. 2025 – Jun. 2025

- Developed a Model Context Protocol (MCP) server integrating financial news APIs with LLM agents for automated news retrieval, sentiment analysis, and summarization workflows.

Co-founder – Neural Wave Lugano 2024

Dec. 2023 – Oct. 2024

- Organized Lugano's first AI-focused hackathon, attracting 100+ participants and sponsors including Bosch, Duferco, and Swisscom.

#herHACK Finalist

Oct. 2022, Nov. 2023

- Finalist projects in digital health for Swiss Post and ESG applications for UBS bank.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, Smalltalk, Java, JavaScript/TypeScript, SQL, C/C++

Backend & Data: FastAPI, SpringBoot, Flask, Node.js/Express, SQLAlchemy/SQLModel, SQLite, PostgreSQL, MySQL, REST/HTTP APIs, MCP

AI & Computer Vision: PyTorch, OpenCV, Ultralytics YOLO, OCR, OpenVINO, ONNX Runtime

Tools & Platforms: Docker, Git/GitHub Actions, Vercel, Raspberry Pi, VisualWorks, GemStone/S, Pharo

LANGUAGES & CERTIFICATIONS

Languages: English (native), Russian (fluent), Italian (intermediate)

Certifications: NVIDIA DLI – *Fundamentals of Deep Learning* (2022), *Analyzing Business Metrics with SQL* (2023)

Hobbies: HAM Radio License Technician Call Sign: KN6QCC, PADI Open Water Scuba, ASA Sailing Cert., avid climber & hiker